UBUNTU PATH MANIFESTO

Together, for Every South African

PREAMBLE

South Africa stands at a historic crossroads. Three decades after democracy, our nation has achieved political freedom, yet millions remain trapped in economic hardship, social fragmentation, and loss of dignity. Ubuntu Path is founded on a simple but powerful belief: **South Africa can only succeed if every South African succeeds**.

Ubuntu Path rejects division based on race, religion, ethnicity, language, or class. We recognise our painful history, but we refuse to be imprisoned by it. Our path forward is unity, competence, ethical leadership, and shared prosperity.

Inspired by:

- **The People's Action Party (PAP) of Singapore** – for its discipline, meritocracy, long-term planning, and corruption-free governance
- **The spirit of Ubuntu,** often translated as "I am because we are." Which emphasizes that an individual's humanity is fostered through relationships, empathy, and community interconnectedness. It promotes communal harmony, collective responsibility and mutual support, over individualism.

Ubuntu Path integrates the strongest principles of each, adapted to South Africa's unique realities.

Our mission is clear:

To use state power as a tool for public empowerment and national enrichment, while unleashing private enterprise to drive growth, innovation, and opportunity.

CORE VALUES

1. Ubuntu (Shared Humanity)

We affirm that a person is a person through others. Government exists to serve people, not dominate them.

2. Unity Over Division

We build one nation, equal citizenship, equal dignity, equal opportunity.

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3. Merit, Discipline, and Competence

Public office is a responsibility, not a reward. Advancement must be based on ability, performance, and integrity.

4. Clean, Ethical Governance

Corruption is a crime against the poor and a betrayal of the nation.

5. Long-Term National Planning

We govern not for elections, but for generations.

6. Empowerment, Not Dependency

Social support must uplift people into independence, productivity and dignity.

CONSTITUTIONAL DEMOCRACY & THE RULE OF LAW

Ubuntu Path fully upholds the Constitution of South Africa as the supreme law.

We commit to:

- Judicial independence
- Separation of powers
- Freedom of speech, belief and association
- Equality before the law
- Protection of minority rights without granting minority veto power over national progress

The law must be firm, fair and applied equally – whether to a president or a citizen.

GOVERNANCE & THE STATE

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A Professional, Capable State

Drawing from Singapore's PAP model, Ubuntu Path will:

- Professionalise the civil service
- Introduce performance-based contracts for senior officials
- Pay competitive but justified salaries tied to outcomes
- Enforce strict anti-corruption laws with mandatory asset declarations

Zero Tolerance for Corruption

- Independent Anti-Corruption Commission with prosecutorial powers
- Mandatory lifestyle audits for public officials
- Severe penalties, including lifetime bans from public office

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RAPID RESPONSE SYSTEM

Ubuntu Path believes that government must be accessible, responsive, and accountable to every citizen – not only during elections, but every single day.

Too many South Africans experience silence, delay, or indifference when reporting service delivery failures, corruption, infrastructure breakdown, or abuse of authority. This erodes trust in the state and weakens national unity.

Ubuntu Path will establish a **Rapid Response System** — a modern, transparent and enforceable public grievance mechanism.

1. A Single National Access Platform

Every citizen will have access to:

- A toll-free national hotline
- A WhatsApp complaint channel
- A secure online portal
- A mobile application

No citizen should struggle to be heard.

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2. Mandatory Response & Resolution Timelines

All complaints will follow strict performance standards:

- 24-hour acknowledgement
- Clear case reference number
- Defined resolution deadline (based on issue type)
- Automatic escalation if deadlines are missed

Government departments and municipalities will be legally required to respond within set timeframes.

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3. Automatic Escalation Mechanism

If a municipality fails to act:

- The matter escalates to provincial oversight
- Continued failure escalates to national oversight
- Persistent negligence triggers administrative investigation

No complaint should disappear into bureaucracy.

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4. Transparency & Public Reporting

Ubuntu Path will introduce a **Public Service Performance Dashboard** that:

- Publishes monthly complaint statistics
- Tracks municipal response times
- Shows resolution rates
- Identifies underperforming departments

Transparency drives discipline.

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5. Independent Oversight

The system will operate under independent statutory authority to prevent:

- Political interference
- Suppression of complaints
- Victimisation of whistleblowers

All citizens, regardless of race, religion, income or political affiliation, will receive equal protection and equal response.

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6. Protection for Whistleblowers

Individuals reporting corruption, crime or abuse will be protected under strengthened whistleblower laws.

Corruption is a crime against the people – and silence protects the corrupt.

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ECONOMIC POLICY: GROWTH WITH JUSTICE

A Mixed Economy for National Development

Ubuntu Path supports a **mixed economic model**:

- Private enterprise as the primary engine of growth
- Strategic state ownership in key sectors
- Public-private partnerships for infrastructure and services

National Development Strategy (20–30 Year Plan)

- Infrastructure-led growth
- Industrialisation and beneficiation
- Export-driven manufacturing
- Skills development aligned to economic needs

STATE-OWNED ENTERPRISES & NATIONAL WEALTH

Strategic State Ownership

Key sectors (energy, transport, water, critical minerals) must serve national interests.

SOEs will be:

- Professionally managed
- Commercially disciplined
- Free from political interference

Sovereign Development Fund

Inspired by **Norway's Sovereign Wealth Fund** and **Singapore's Temasek and GIC (Government Investment Company)** :

- Pool strategic national assets
- Invest for long-term national benefit
- Fund education, healthcare, infrastructure, and future generations

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SMALL BUSINESS, ENTREPRENEURSHIP & JOB CREATION

Ubuntu Path prioritises **job creation over job promises**.

We will:

- Simplify business registration to under 48 hours
- Reduce red tape for small businesses
- Provide micro-financing and mentorship
- Support township and rural enterprises
- Encourage cooperatives and community-owned businesses

LABOUR & WORKERS

We support workers' rights and fair labour practices, while ensuring economic competitiveness.

- Skills-based wage growth
- Apprenticeships and vocational training
- Productivity-linked incentives
- Protection against exploitation

Work must restore dignity, not trap people in poverty.

SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT & HUMAN DIGNITY

A Hand Up, Not a Handout

Social grants remain essential but must be linked to:

- Education
- Skills training
- Community service where appropriate

The goal is transition from dependency to independence.

Housing

- Mixed-income developments
- Secure property rights
- Affordable rental housing
- Efficient land use near economic hubs

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EDUCATION: THE FOUNDATION OF THE FUTURE

Early Childhood Development

- Universal access to quality ECD
- Nutrition and parental support

Schooling

- Teacher accountability and support
- Strong emphasis on literacy, numeracy, science, and technology
- National values and civic education

Tertiary & Skills Education

- Expanded TVET colleges
- Industry-linked curricula
- Merit-based and needs-based funding. Education must prepare citizens for real work in a modern economy.

HEALTHCARE

Ubuntu Path supports universal access to quality healthcare.

- Strengthened public healthcare system
- Ethical, phased and financially sustainable NHI
- Partnerships with private healthcare
- Focus on prevention, mental health and primary care

Healthcare is a right, but it must be delivered competently.

SAFETY, SECURITY & JUSTICE

Crime & Policing

- Professional, well-trained police service
- Community policing partnerships
- Strong intelligence-led crime prevention

Justice System

- Faster courts
- Victim-centred justice
- Rehabilitation alongside punishment

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No society can thrive without safety.

LAND, AGRICULTURE & FOOD SECURITY

Ubuntu Path supports land reform that is:

- Lawful
- Fair
- Productive

We reject reckless expropriation that destroys food security.

- Secure tenure for beneficiaries
- Support for emerging farmers
- Commercial partnerships and mentorship

ENVIRONMENT & SUSTAINABILITY

- Responsible use of natural resources
- Renewable energy expansion
- Climate adaptation strategies
- Environmental protection balanced with development

We protect nature for future generations.

FOREIGN POLICY & INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Ubuntu Path pursues a **non-aligned, interest-based foreign policy**.

- Peaceful international cooperation
- Fair trade partnerships
- South-South and Global North engagement
- African continental development

South Africa must be respected, principled and pragmatic.

NATIONAL IDENTITY & SOCIAL COHESION

Ubuntu Path promotes:

- Shared national identity
- Cultural freedom without political division
- Civic responsibility and mutual respect

We are many histories, but one future.

CONCLUSION: THE UBUNTU PATH FORWARD

Ubuntu Path is not a protest movement.
It is not a racial project.
It is not an ideology trapped in the past.

It is a **nation-building project**.

We invite every South African – worker, entrepreneur, student, elder, believer, skeptic – to walk this path together.

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